آغا خان یونیورسٹی ایگزامینیشن بورڈ

AGA KHAN UNIVERSITY EXAMINATION BOARD

Notes from E-Marking Centre on SSC-I Pakistan Studies Annual Examinations 2025

Introduction

This document has been produced for the teachers and candidates of Secondary School Certificate (SSC) Part I Pakistan Studies. It contains comments on candidates' responses to the 2025 SSC-I Examination, indicating the quality of the responses and highlighting their relative strengths and weaknesses.

E-Marking Notes

This includes overall comments on candidates' performance on every question and *some* specific examples of candidates' responses that support the mentioned comments. Please note that the descriptive comments represent an overall perception of the better and weaker responses as gathered from the e-marking session. However, the candidates' responses shared in this document represent some specific example(s) of the mentioned comments.

Teachers and candidates should be aware that examiners may ask questions that address the Student Learning Outcomes (SLOs) in a manner that requires candidates to respond by integrating knowledge, understanding, and application skills they have developed during study. Candidates are advised to read and comprehend each question carefully before writing their response to fulfill the demand of the question.

Candidates need to be aware that the marks allocated to the questions are related to the answer space provided on the examination paper as a guide to the length of the required response. A longer response will not in itself lead to higher marks. Candidates need to be familiar with the command words in the SLOs, which contain terms commonly used in examination questions. However, candidates should also be aware that not all questions will start with or contain one of the command words. Words such as 'how', 'why', or 'what' may also be used. It is imperative to refer to the command word guide available on the AKU-EB website for understanding the expectations of the command word.

General Observations

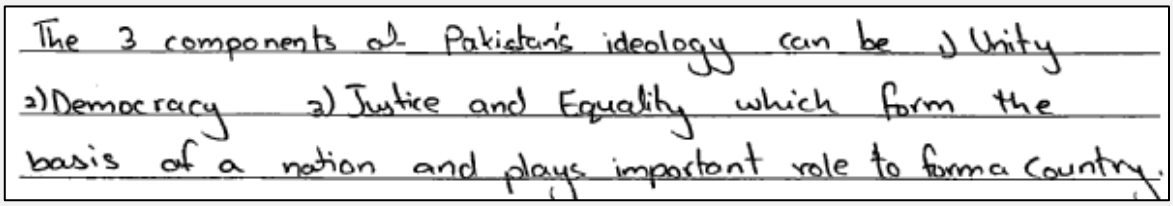
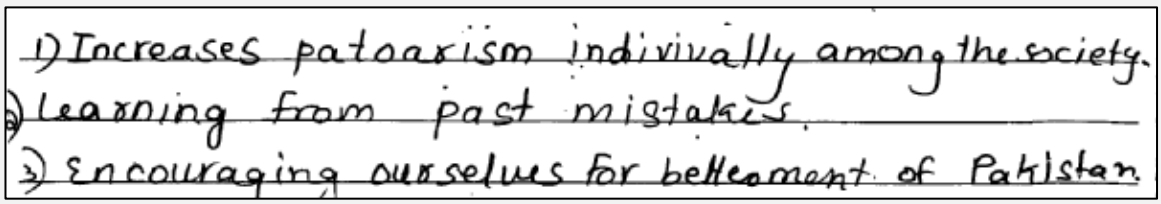
Most candidates were able to construct strong responses, especially on topics such as evaluating Pakistan's success in addressing its early challenges, suggesting individual actions to reduce the impact of global warming, explaining the economic importance of forests, and analysing the reasons behind the All-India Muslim League's success in the 1945–1946 elections. However, teachers should give more focus, drills, and practice on the following areas to strengthen students' understanding:

- The key components of Pakistan's ideology.
- The role of the irrigation system in supporting agricultural and economic development in Pakistan.

Note: Candidates' responses shown in this report have not been corrected for grammar, spelling, format, or information.

DETAILED COMMENTS

Constructed Response Questions (CRQs)

Question No. 1	
Question Text	List any THREE components of Pakistan's ideology.
SLO No.	1.3.2
SLO Text	Extract the components of Pakistan's ideology from above mentioned speeches;
Max Marks	3
Cognitive Level	K*
Checking Hints	Give ONE mark for mentioning each component (THREE required).
Overall Performance	The question was not attempted well by the candidates. Some of the candidates mentioned the key components of Pakistan's ideology. However, most candidates highlighted the importance of ideology for a nation or wrote about the importance of the Two-Nation Theory.
Description of Better Responses	In *better responses*, it was evident that candidates understood the components of the ideology of Pakistan as rooted in key Islamic principles such as the sovereignty of Allah Almighty, brotherhood, social justice, equality, and minorities' rights. Many candidates also highlighted the role of democracy in governance. Their answers reflected the values that form the foundation of Pakistan.
Image of Better Response	 The 3 components of Pakistan's ideology can be 1) Unity 2) Democracy 3) Justice and Equality which form the basis of a nation and plays important role to form a country.
Description of Weaker Responses	It was observed in *weaker responses* that candidates misunderstood the question. Instead of listing components of Pakistan's ideology, the candidates described general outcomes or effects, such as patriotism, learning from mistakes, and working for national betterment. These responses were too vague and did not reflect the actual ideological foundations. Students did not follow the expectation of the command word and unnecessarily elaborated on the concept.
Image of Weaker Response	 1) Increases patoarism indivually among the society. 2) Learning from past mistakes. 3) Encouraging ourselves for betterment of Pakistan.

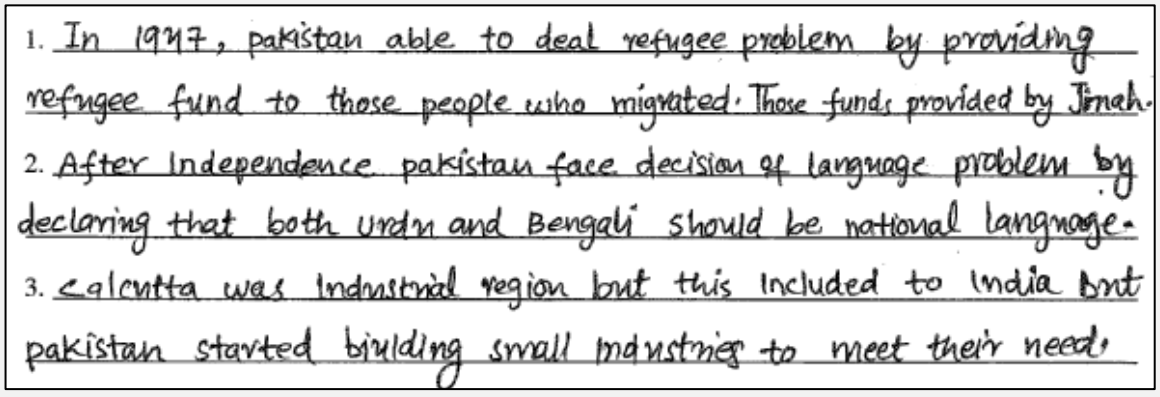
Suggestions for improvement (Highlight all that apply)

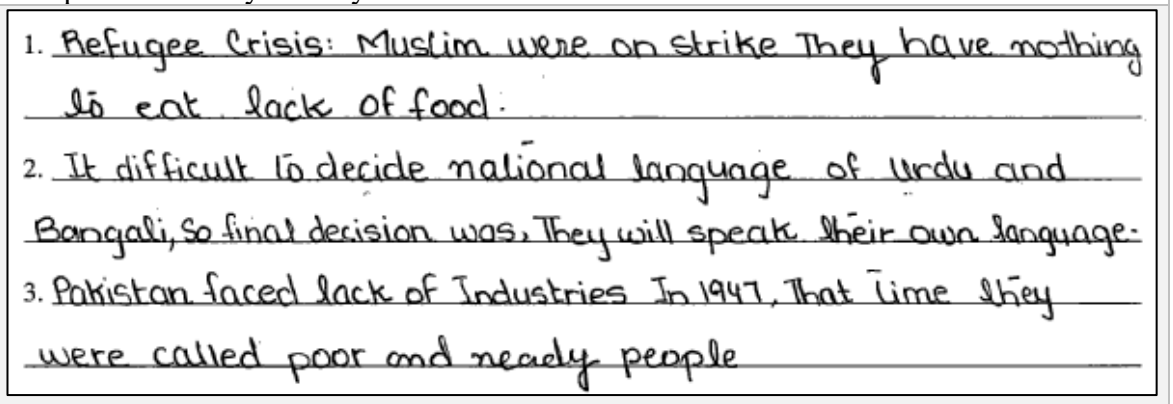
Maximising SLO Achievement	Preferred Pedagogy** Used for this SLO	Assessment Strategies
• Identify the expectation of command words (use Command Word Guide) • Ensure the content is taught at the relevant cognitive level • Identify necessary content required (skills + concepts)	• Story Board • Cause and Effect • Fish and Bone • Concept Mapping • Audio Visual Resources • Think, Pair and Share • Knowledge Platform videos	• Past paper questions • Discussion on E-Marking Notes • AKU-EB Digital Learning Solution powered by Knowledge Platform https://akueb.knowledgeplatform.com/login

• Review past paper questions on the concept • Utilise the resource guide for additional materials	• Questioning Technique (Socratic approach) • Practical Demonstration ** For a description of each Pedagogy, refer to Annexure A	

Any Additional Suggestion: Teachers are recommended to use concept maps to clarify the difference between ideological components and their outcomes. Visual aids and mnemonics can help reinforce the six key principles of Pakistan's ideology. Active strategies like discussions, role-plays, and jigsaw reading can deepen understanding. Teachers should also emphasise key vocabulary and provide model answers with timely, focused feedback to improve clarity and accuracy.

*K = Knowledge U = Understanding A = Application and other higher-order cognitive skills

Question No. 2	
Question Text	In 1947, Pakistan faced three major problems: • Refugee Crisis • Decision of a National Language • Lack of Industries How was Pakistan able to deal with each of the given problems? Mention ONE strategy used by Pakistan to deal with each of the given problems.
SLO No.	3.4.2
SLO Text	Evaluate how successful Pakistan was in overcoming the initial problems;
Max Marks	3
Cognitive Level	U
Checking Hints	Give ONE mark for mentioning each solution (THREE required).
Overall Performance	The overall performance of this question was good. Most candidates were able to provide a solution to the problems mentioned in the question. However, some of them did not address the issue of the problems given with a solution; they simply noted that Pakistan was seen as a poor and needy country.
Description of Better Responses	In *better responses*, candidates clearly explained how Pakistan tackled major post-independence challenges. They mentioned Jinnah's role as Governor-General in addressing the refugee crisis by providing shelter and support. For the language issue, they noted that Urdu was declared the national language, later joined by Bengali. To overcome the lack of industries, candidates highlighted the government's efforts to promote industrialisation through private investment, textile development, and foreign aid, laying the foundation for economic growth.
Image of Better Response	 1. In 1947, pakistan able to deal refugee problem by providing refugee fund to those people who migrated. Those funds provided by Jinnah. 2. After Independence pakistan face decision of language problem by declaring that both urdu and Bengali should be national langnage. 3. Calcutta was Industrial region but this included to India but pakistan started bivlding small industries to meet their need.
Description of Weaker Responses	Some candidates were unable to suggest effective solutions to the problems faced. They mentioned that Muslims went on strike, but did not explain how this helped resolve the issue. They also failed to discuss the national language clearly and instead stated that people were allowed to speak their own languages. In addition, rather than addressing the

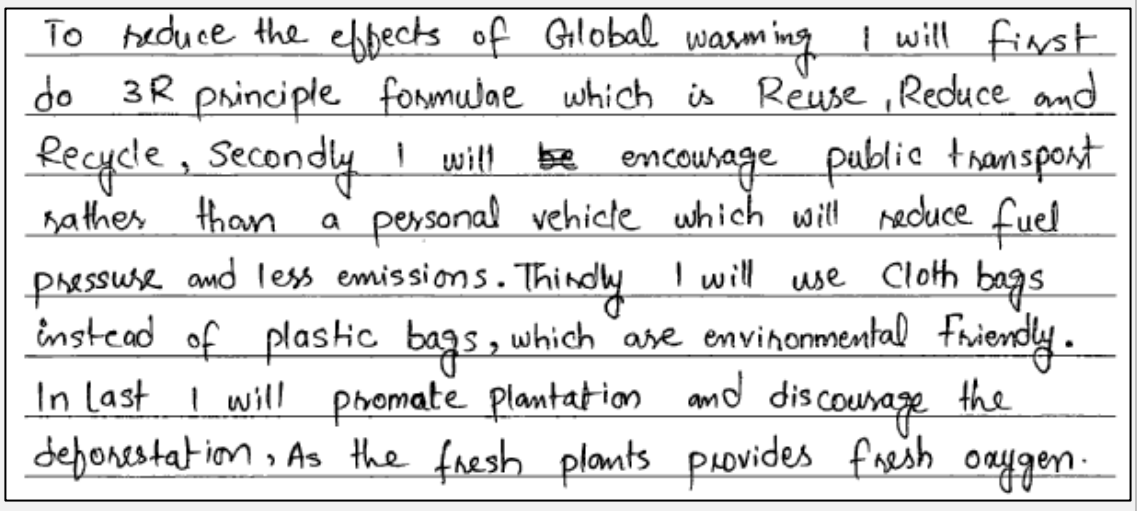
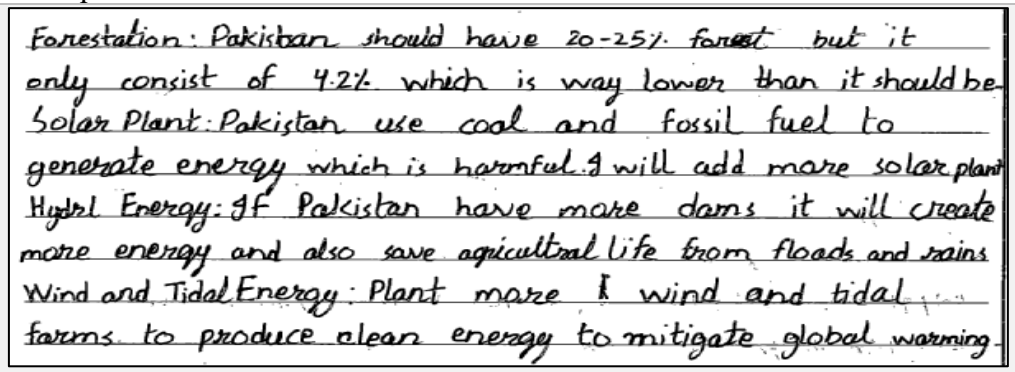
	issue of industrial development with a solution, they simply noted that Pakistan was seen as a poor and needy country.
Image of Weaker Response	

Suggestions for improvement (Highlight all that apply)

Maximising SLO Achievement	Preferred Pedagogy Used for this SLO	Assessment Strategies
• Identify the expectation of command words (use Command Word Guide) • Ensure the content is taught at the relevant cognitive level • Identify necessary content required (skills + concepts) • Review past paper questions on the concept • Utilise the resource guide for additional materials	• Story Board • Cause and Effect • Fish and Bone • Concept Mapping • Audio Visual Resources • Think, Pair and Share • Knowledge Platform videos • Questioning Technique (Socratic approach) • Practical Demonstration	• Past paper questions • Discussion on E-Marking Notes • AKU-EB Digital Learning Solution powered by Knowledge Platform https://akueb.knowledgeplatform.com/login

Any Additional Suggestion: To teach this topic effectively, the teachers should use a student-centred approach by discussing the early challenges faced by Pakistan after independence. Using case studies, visuals, and timelines can help students understand issues like the refugee crisis, language problems, and economic difficulties. Group discussions and role-plays can encourage critical thinking, guiding students to suggest practical solutions and helping them connect historical events with national development and decision-making.

Question No. 3	
Question Text	Pakistan is not a major contributor to global warming; however, it is one of the countries most severely impacted by its consequences. As a student, what FOUR actions can you take to mitigate (lessen) the effects of global warming in Pakistan?
SLO No.	4.4.5
SLO Text	Suggest remedies to lessen the effect of global warming on Pakistan (at an individual level, at the government level);
Max Marks	4
Cognitive Level	A
Checking Hints	Give ONE mark for each suggestion (FOUR required). Any relevant point will be awarded marks.

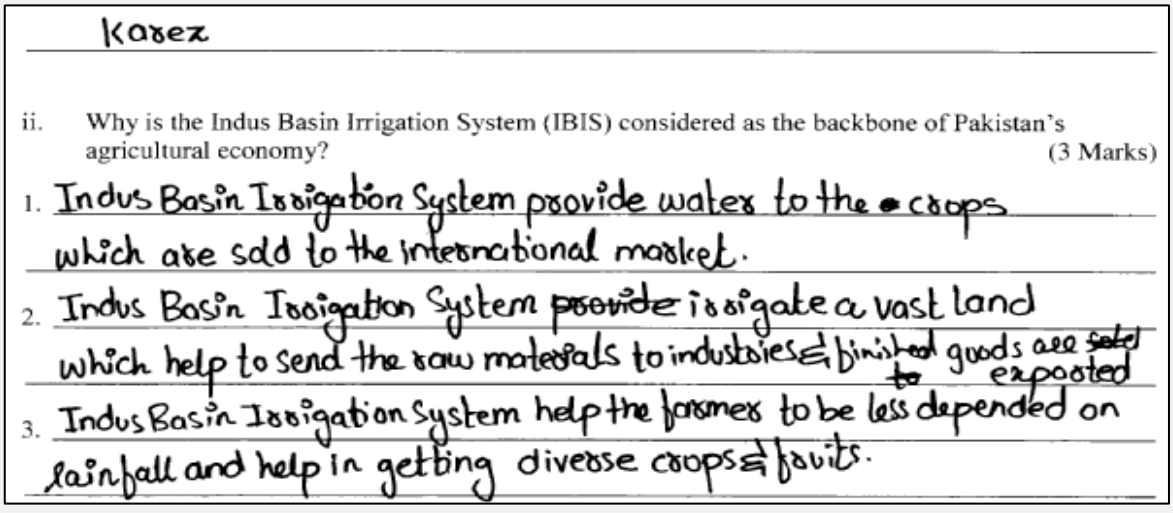
Overall Performance	The question was generally answered well, and most candidates met its requirements by clearly suggesting the role of an individual student in reducing the effects of global warming in Pakistan. However, some candidates focused more on the impact and causes of climate change on the environment or repeated the climate-related details already given in the question, instead of providing relevant suggestions.
Description of Better Responses	Most candidates suggested practical ways students can help reduce global warming. They proposed planting and caring for trees, reducing air conditioning use, and conserving water while brushing or washing. Carpooling with classmates was highlighted to cut pollution, along with following the 3Rs principle (reduce, reuse, recycle) to minimise waste. Candidates also stressed switching off unnecessary lights and fans to save electricity. Such actions show how students can make a meaningful contribution to a sustainable environment.
Image of Better Response	 To reduce the effects of Global warming I will first do 3R principle formulae which is Reuse, Reduce and Recycle, Secondly I will ~~be~~ encourage public transport rather than a personal vehicle which will reduce fuel pressure and less emissions. Thirdly I will use Cloth bags instead of plastic bags, which are environmental friendly. In last I will promote plantation and discourage the deforestation, As the fresh plants provides fresh oxygen.
Description of Weaker Responses	Some candidates focused on describing the effects of global warming on the environment rather than proposing solutions from a student's perspective to reduce its impact. Additionally, a few responses included the use of alternative energy sources by the government rather than by an individual, which was not aligned with the specific demand of the question.
Image of Weaker Response	 Forestation: Pakistan should have 20-25% forest but it only consist of 4.2% which is way lower than it should be. Solar Plant: Pakistan use coal and fossil fuel to generate energy which is harmful. I will add more solar plant Hydel Energy: If Pakistan have more dams it will create more energy and also save agricultral life from floods and rains Wind and Tidal Energy: Plant more I wind and tidal farms to produce clean energy to mitigate global warming.

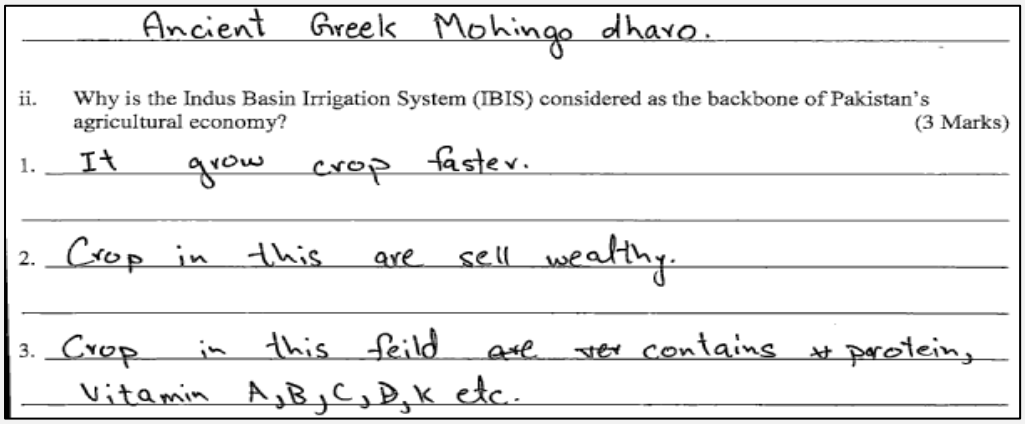
Suggestions for improvement (Highlight all that apply)

Maximising SLO Achievement	Preferred Pedagogy Used for this SLO	Assessment Strategies
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• Identify necessary content required (skills + concepts) • Review past paper questions on the concept • Utilise the resource guide for additional materials	• Knowledge Platform videos • Questioning Technique (Socratic approach) • Practical Demonstration	

Any Additional Suggestion: To effectively teach these concepts, teachers should adopt interactive and student-centred strategies. They can begin with real-life examples and short videos to explain global warming and its local impact. Encourage brainstorming sessions where students suggest practical actions they can take individually. Use activities like role-plays, group discussions, and poster-making on eco-friendly habits. Teachers should also design formative assessments and reflection tasks to reinforce understanding and guide students to apply these concepts in daily life.

Question No. 4	
Question Text	i. Name the ancient irrigation system used in Balochistan. ii. Why is the Indus Basin Irrigation System (IBIS) considered as the backbone of Pakistan's agricultural economy?
SLO No.	5.4.2
SLO Text	Explain the importance of irrigation in Pakistan;
Max Marks	4
Cognitive Level	U
Checking Hints	Give ONE mark for naming the traditional irrigation system used in Balochistan. Give ONE mark for mentioning each reason (any THREE required).
Overall Performance	It was observed that most candidates did not perform well on this question. They confused the importance of the irrigation system with the importance of growing crops in Pakistan's development, rather than focusing specifically on how the irrigation system supports agricultural and economic growth.
Description of Better Responses	In *better responses,* most candidates responded by explaining that Karez is one of the oldest traditional irrigation systems in Balochistan. They also mentioned that Pakistan has an integrated irrigation network, which is essential because the country is mostly semi-arid to arid, with insufficient rainfall for crop production, especially in South Punjab and the Sindh plain. Candidates highlighted that Pakistan is an agricultural country, where most people depend on farming, growing fruits and vegetables, which contribute around 70% to the nation's food production.
Image of Better Response	 Karez ii. Why is the Indus Basin Irrigation System (IBIS) considered as the backbone of Pakistan's agricultural economy? (3 Marks) 1. Indus Basin Irrigation System provide water to the crops which are sold to the international market. 2. Indus Basin Irrigation System provide irrigate a vast land which help to send the raw materials to industries & finished goods are exported to 3. Indus Basin Irrigation System help the farmers to be less depended on rainfall and help in getting diverse crops & fruits.

Description of Weaker Responses	In *weaker responses*, some candidates stated that the irrigation system helps crops grow faster and makes them healthier. They further mentioned that crops contain nutrients such as proteins and vitamins. However, these responses reflected a misunderstanding of the question, as they focused more on the nutritional value of crops rather than explaining the role and importance of the irrigation system in agricultural and economic development.
Image of Weaker Response	 Ancient Greek Mohingo dharo. ii. Why is the Indus Basin Irrigation System (IBIS) considered as the backbone of Pakistan's agricultural economy? (3 Marks) 1. It grow crop faster. 2. Crop in this are sell wealthy. 3. Crop in this feild are ver contains * protein, Vitamin A, B, C, D, K etc.

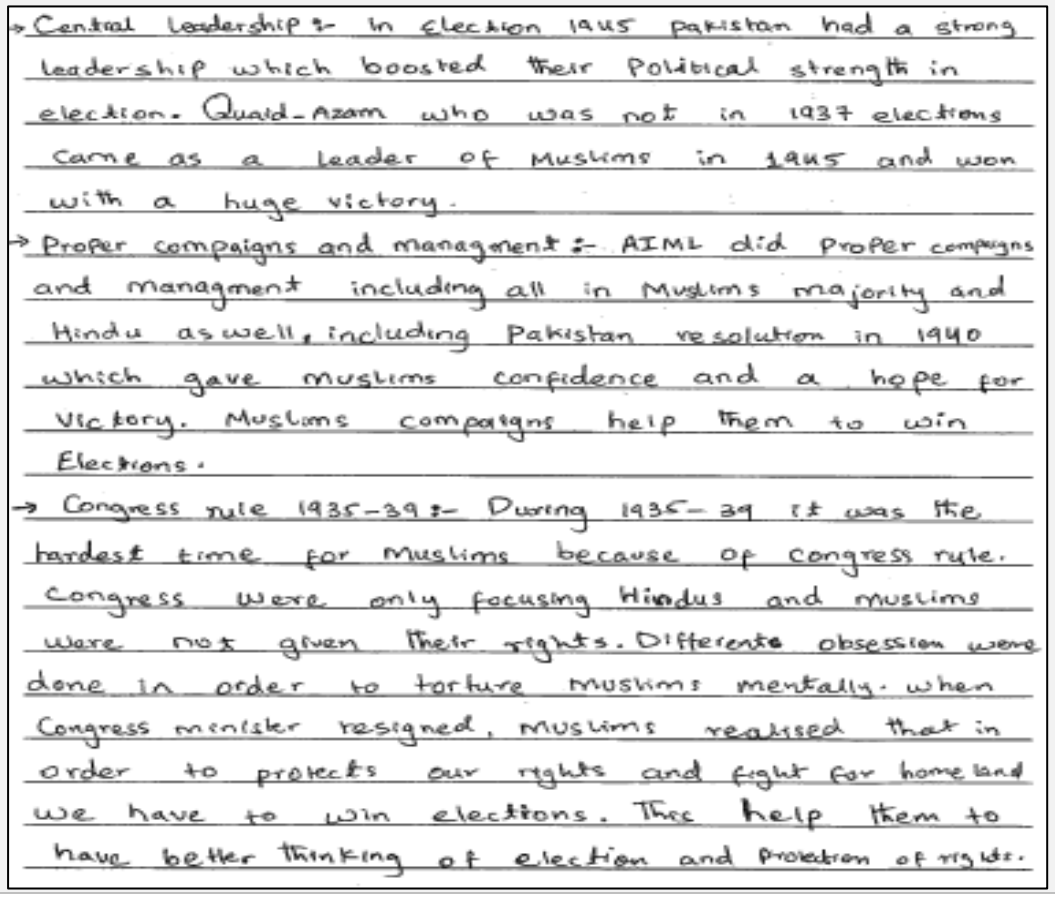
Suggestions for improvement (Highlight all that apply)

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Any Additional Suggestion: To teach this concept effectively, teachers should explain the role of the irrigation system in supporting agriculture, especially in arid regions like South Punjab and Sindh. They can use diagrams, videos, and real-life examples to show how irrigation improves crop yield and contributes to economic growth. Comparing traditional and modern methods, such as Karez and canal systems, through group work or discussions can help students clearly understand the link between irrigation and national development.

Extended Response Questions (ERQs)

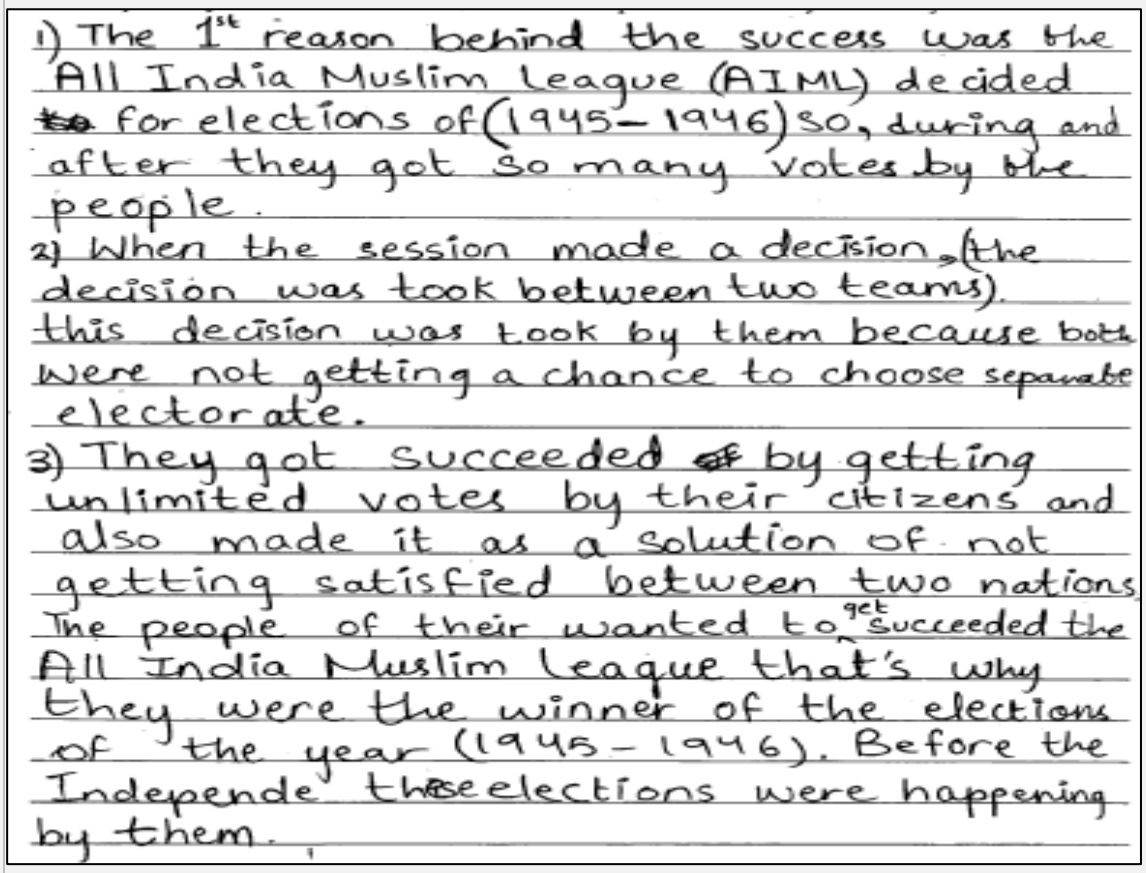
Extended response questions offered a choice between parts 'a' and 'b'

Question No. 5a	
Question Text	Analyse any THREE reasons behind the success of the All-India Muslim League in the general elections of 1945-1946.
SLO No.	3.2.3
SLO Text	Analyse the reasons behind the difference between the results of the elections of 1936-37 and 1945-46;
Max Marks	06
Cognitive Level	A
Checking Hints	Give ONE mark for mentioning each reason (THREE required). Give ONE mark for analysing each reason (THREE required).
Overall Performance	About half of the candidates chose option A for the extended response question. Overall, they responded well, with most candidates able to analyse the reasons behind the success of the All-India Muslim League in the 1945–1946 general elections. However, some candidates showed a misunderstanding by stating that the League won the elections because of the separate electorate, which was a factor in the system but not the main reason for their success.
Description of Better Responses	*Better responses* responded by explaining that the All-India Muslim League became more popular in the 1945–1946 elections due to several key factors. They mentioned that the political climate had changed since 1937, with growing support for independence and clearer divisions between Congress and the Muslim League. The candidates further mentioned that under Jinnah's strong leadership, the League became more organised. The demand for Pakistan, rising communal tensions, and the impact of World War II also influenced voters and strengthened the League's position.
Image of Better Response	

→ Central Leadership :- In election 1945 pakistan had a strong leadership which boosted their Political strength in election. Quaid-Azam who was not in 1937 elections came as a leader of Muslims in 1945 and won with a huge victory.

→ Proper compaigns and management :- AIML did proper compaigns and managment including all in Muslims majority and Hindu as well, including Pakistan resolution in 1940 which gave muslims confidence and a hope for victory. Muslims compaigns help them to win Elections.

→ Congress rule 1935-39 :- During 1935-39 it was the hardest time for Muslims because of congress rule. Congress were only focusing Hindus and muslims were not given their rights. Differente obsession were done in order to torture muslims mentally. when Congress menister resigned, muslims realised that in order to protects our rights and fight for home land we have to win elections. This help them to have better thinking of election and Protection of rights.

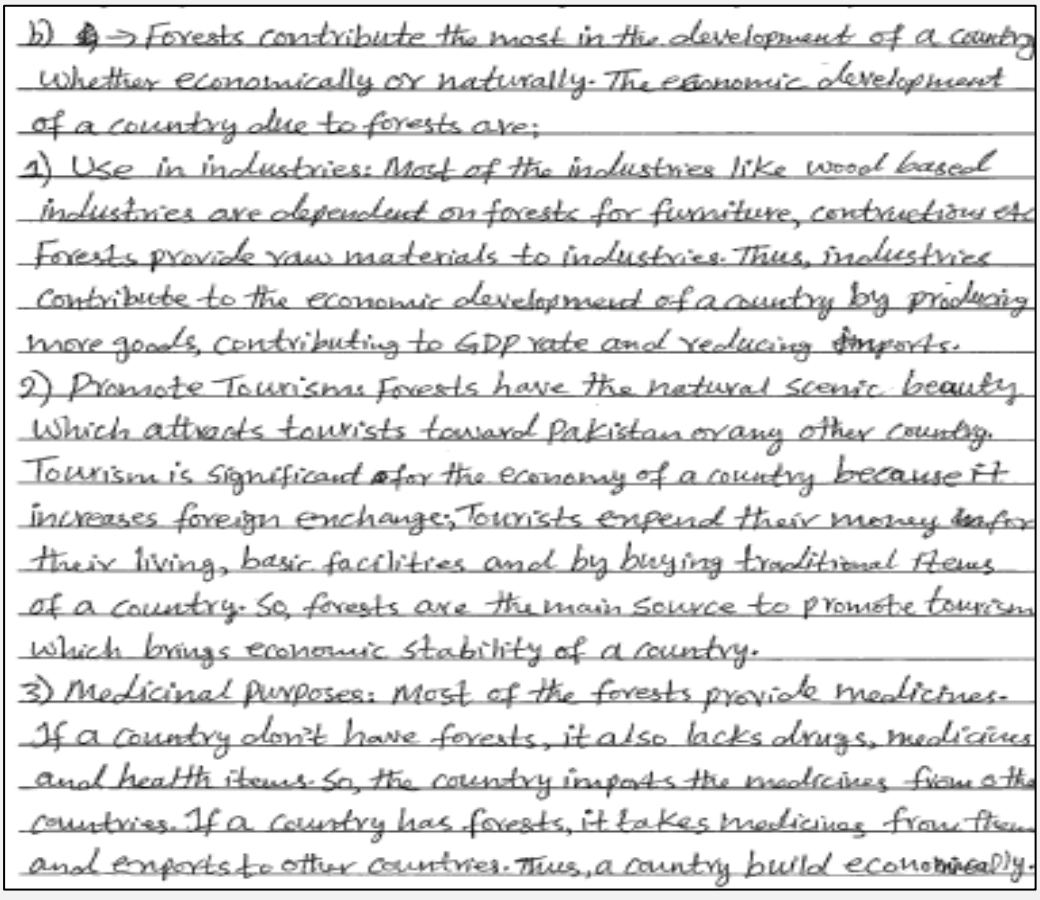
Description of Weaker Responses	Several candidates struggled to answer this question accurately and provided incorrect reasons for the All-India Muslim League's success in the 1945–1946 general elections. One common mistake was the claim that the League's victory was primarily due to the separate electorate system. While the separate electorate was indeed part of the political framework at the time, it was not the main factor behind the League's triumph. This explanation overlooks the broader context, such as the growing support for the League's demand for Pakistan, Jinnah's leadership, and effective campaigning, which played a more significant role in their electoral success.
Image of Weaker Response	

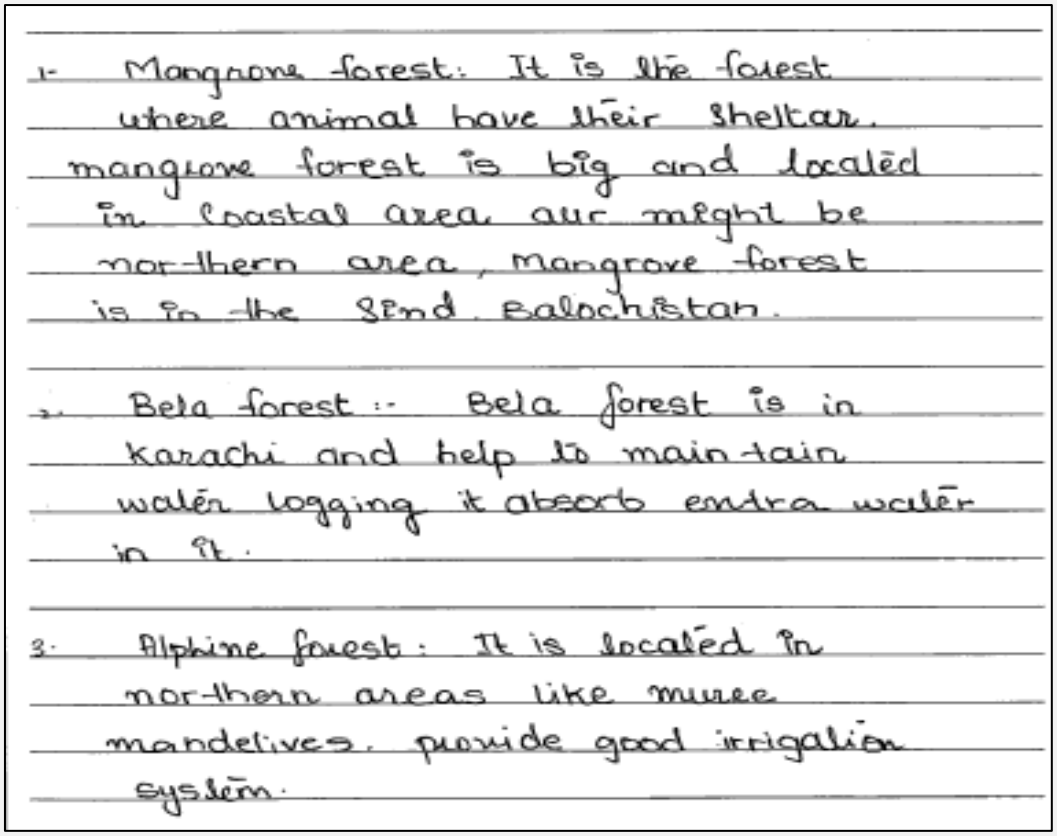
1) The 1st reason behind the success was the All India Muslim League (AIML) decided for elections of (1945–1946) so, during and after they got so many votes by the people.
2) When the session made a decision, (the decision was took between two teams). this decision was took by them because both were not getting a chance to choose separate electorate.
3) They got succeeded by getting unlimited votes by their citizens and also made it as a solution of not getting satisfied between two nations. The people of their wanted to, get succeeded the All India Muslim League that's why they were the winner of the elections of the year (1945–1946). Before the Independe those elections were happening by them.

Suggestions for improvement (Highlight all that apply)

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Any Additional Suggestion: To teach this concept effectively, teachers can use storytelling to explain the historical background of the 1945–46 elections, highlighting key events and leaders like Muhammad Ali Jinnah. Comparing the 1937 and 1945 elections through timelines or charts can help students see the political shift. Group discussions, debates, and role-plays can deepen understanding of the Muslim League's success. Using primary sources and visual aids can further enhance engagement and critical thinking.

Question No. 5b	
Question Text	Explain any THREE roles of forests in the development of a country's economy.
SLO No.	5.5.2
SLO Text	Discuss the economic importance of forests for Pakistan;
Max Marks	6
Cognitive Level	U
Checking Hints	Give ONE mark for mentioning each role (any THREE required). Give an additional mark if each role is well explained. No more than ONE mark will be awarded if roles are written in bullet points (THREE required).
Overall Performance	Overall, candidates responded well to this question. Many were able to understand and address its main requirements. However, some candidates faced difficulty in clearly explaining the economic importance of forests. Instead of discussing how forests support the economy, such as through timber, employment, and export, they focused mainly on their physical and natural benefits, like providing oxygen and shelter for animals, which did not fully meet the question's demand.
Description of Better Responses	In *better responses,* candidates explained that forests have several economic benefits. They mentioned that forests provide raw materials like wood pulp for paper industries and timber for construction. Firewood and charcoal are used as fuel and can be sold for income. The candidates mentioned that forests also create job opportunities through conservation and management. Additionally, exporting forest products increases national income. Some candidates also noted that forests attract tourists due to their natural beauty and wildlife, boosting the tourism industry.
Image of Better Response	 b) ⇒ Forests contribute the most in the development of a country whether economically or naturally. The economic development of a country due to forests are: 1) Use in industries: Most of the industries like wood based industries are dependent on forests for furniture, contructions etc. Forests provide raw materials to industries. Thus, industries contribute to the economic development of a country by producing more goods, contributing to GDP rate and reducing imports. 2) Promote Tourism: Forests have the natural scenic beauty which attracts tourists toward Pakistan or any other country. Tourism is significant for the economy of a country because it increases foreign exchange; Tourists expend their money for their living, basic facilities and by buying traditional items of a country. So, forests are the main source to promote tourism which brings economic stability of a country. 3) Medicinal purposes: Most of the forests provide medicines. If a country don't have forests, it also lacks drugs, medicines and health items. So, the country imports the medicines from other countries. If a country has forests, it takes medicines from them and exports to other countries. Thus, a country build economically.
Description of Weaker Responses	Some candidates discussed different types of forests found in Pakistan. They also suggested that farmers should use advanced machinery for harvesting and high-quality seeds to produce healthier crops. Additionally, a few candidates recommended using the drip irrigation system to water forest plants, believing it would help them grow

	better. However, these responses showed a lack of focus on the economic importance of forests, as required by the question.
Image of Weaker Response	

1- Mangrove forest: It is the forest where animal have their sheltar. mangrove forest is big and located in coastal area our might be northern area, Mangrove forest is in the Sind Balochistan.

2. Bela forest :- Bela forest is in karachi and help to main-tain water logging it absorb extra water in it.

3. Alpine fouest : It is located in northern areas like muree mandelives. provide good irrigation system.

Suggestions for improvement (Highlight all that apply)

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Any Additional Suggestion: To teach the concept of the economic importance of forests, teachers should use interactive strategies such as case studies, visual aids, and group activities. They can begin with real-life examples of forest-based industries in Pakistan and their role in the economy. A comparison chart showing physical vs. economic benefits can help clarify the difference. Role-plays, map work, and field trips (or virtual tours) can also enhance understanding by linking theory to real-world applications.

Annexure A: Pedagogies Used for Teaching the SLOs

Pedagogy: Storyboard
Description: A visual pedagogy that uses a series of illustrated panels to present a narrative, encouraging creativity and critical thinking. It helps learners organise ideas, sequence events, and comprehend complex concepts through storytelling.
Example: In a Literature class, students are tasked with creating storyboards to visually retell a novel. They draw key scenes, write captions, and present their stories to the class, enhancing their reading comprehension and fostering their imagination.

Pedagogy: Cause and Effect
Description: This pedagogy explores the relationships between actions and consequences. By analysing cause-and-effect relationships, learners develop a deeper understanding of how events are interconnected and how one action can lead to various outcomes.
Example: In a History class, students study the causes and effects of the Industrial Revolution. They research and discuss how technological advancements in manufacturing led to significant societal changes, such as urbanisation and labour reform movements.

Pedagogy: Fish and Bone
Description: A method that breaks down complex topics into main ideas (the fish) and supporting details (the bones). This visual approach enhances comprehension by highlighting essential concepts and their relevant explanations.
Example: During a Biology class on human anatomy, the teacher uses the fish and bone technique to teach about the human skeletal system. Teacher presents the main components of the human skeleton (fish) and elaborates on each bone's structure and function (bones).

Pedagogy: Concept Mapping
Description: An effective way to visually represent relationships between ideas. Learners create diagrams connecting key concepts, aiding in understanding the overall structure of a subject and fostering retention.
Example: In a Psychology assignment, students use concept mapping to explore the various theories of personality. They interlink different theories, such as Freud's psychoanalysis, Jung's analytical psychology, and Bandura's social-cognitive theory, to see how they relate to each other.

Pedagogy: Audio Visual Resources
Description: Incorporating multimedia elements like videos, images, and audio into lessons. This approach caters to different learning styles, making educational content more engaging and memorable.
Example: In a General Science class, the teacher uses a documentary-style video to teach about the solar system. The video includes stunning visual animations of the planets, interviews with astronomers, and background music, enhancing students' interest and understanding of space.

Pedagogy: Think, Pair, and Share
Description: A collaborative learning technique where students ponder a question or problem individually, then discuss their thoughts in pairs or small groups before sharing with the entire class. It fosters active participation, communication skills, and diverse perspectives.
Example: In a Literature in English class, the teacher poses a thought-provoking question about a novel's moral dilemma. Students first reflect individually, then pair up to exchange their opinions, and finally participate in a lively class discussion to explore different viewpoints.

Pedagogy: Questioning Technique (Socratic Approach)
Description: Based on Socratic dialogue, this method stimulates critical thinking by posing thought-provoking questions. It encourages learners to explore ideas, justify their reasoning, and discover knowledge through a process of inquiry.
Example: In an Ethics class, the instructor uses the Socratic approach to lead a discussion on the meaning of justice. By asking a series of probing questions, the students engage in a deeper exploration of ethical principles and societal values.

Pedagogy: Practical Demonstration
Description: A hands-on approach where learners observe real-life applications of theories or skills. Practical demonstrations enhance comprehension, skill acquisition, and problem-solving abilities by bridging theoretical concepts with real-world scenarios.
Example: In a Food and Nutrition class, the instructor demonstrates the proper technique for filleting a fish. Students observe and then practice the skill themselves, learning the practical application of knife skills and culinary precision.

(**Note:** The examples provided in this annexure serve as illustrations of various pedagogies. It is important to understand that these pedagogies are versatile and can be applied across subjects in numerous ways. Feel free to adapt and explore these techniques creatively to enhance learning outcomes in your specific context.)

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